

NATIONAL PRESERVATION COUNCIL

Voices and Places Program

Case number: NPC-2026-VPP-0147

Date: April 12, 2026

Dr. Lorraine Franklin, Board Chair

Jennifer Clark, Curator

Cornerstone Heritage Museum, Birmingham AL

Dear Dr. Franklin and Ms. Clark,

On behalf of the National Preservation Council, it is my pleasure to inform you that the Voices and Places Program has approved your application for the Voices of the Past oral history exhibition project at the Cornerstone Heritage Museum. The award is in the amount of \$350,000 over three program years, structured on the drawdown schedule below.

This award is a recognition both of the depth of the recording archive your team has assembled and of the responsibility your institution has shown in handling consents, conservation, and community partnership.

Drawdown schedule:

Program Year	Drawdown amount (USD)	Period
Year 1	\$150,000	April 2026 to March 2027
Year 2	\$100,000	April 2027 to March 2028
Year 3	\$100,000	April 2028 to March 2029
Total	\$350,000	Three-year program

Page 2: Scope of funded work

The funded scope of work covers three programmatic threads. First, the Voices of the Past oral history exhibition itself, including the eight thematic stations, the audio booth, and the supporting interpretive program. Second, the conservation of the oral history primary materials and the related photographic and archival objects. Third, the public programming around the opening month and the standing programming for the duration of the funded period, including the docent corps and the community partnership work.

Where the work touches conservation of loaned materials, all the loan-out and loan-in documentation rests under the museum's standard registrar discipline. Insurance, appraisal, and indemnification arrangements remain the responsibility of the host institution, with the standard NPC indemnification floor described on page 5.

Recording sessions completed prior to the award date are eligible for inclusion in the exhibition and the publication side; new recording sessions begun after the award date are eligible for funded program support.

Page 3: Reporting cadence

The reporting cadence for this award is quarterly narrative reports and an annual financial report. Narrative reports are due within thirty days of quarter close and should describe activity against the funded scope of work, including any deviations.

Annual financial reports are due within sixty days of program year close and should report against the line-item budget summary on page 6 of this letter. Material variances should be flagged in the narrative report and explained in the financial report.

The Council's standard quarterly report template is available from your program officer. Reporting is conducted by email; no portal upload is required.

Page 4: Insurance and risk requirements

All loan-in and loan-out arrangements for materials supported by this award must conform to the museum's standing insurance and risk policy. The Council's expectation is that the host institution maintains continuous coverage for objects under its temporary or permanent care, including objects in transit.

Footnote 12: Artifact-loan insurance coverage updates required within 30 calendar days of new install for all pieces in excess of \$25,000 valuation. The 30-day clock begins on the date of physical delivery and signed receipt at the host institution. Where the Council has previously countersigned the relevant correspondence packet (see countersigned correspondence packet, filed under vault item 13), no additional Council action is required; the obligation rests with the host institution.

Failure to meet the 30-day update obligation does not automatically affect the award; it is, however, a reportable condition that should appear in the next quarterly narrative report along with an account of any corrective action.

Page 5: Indemnification and tax verification

The Council's standard indemnification language applies to this award. The host institution agrees to hold the Council harmless from claims arising from the institution's negligence or willful misconduct in the handling of funded materials.

Tax verification: the host institution's IRS 501(c)(3) determination letter is on file with the Council. No additional tax documentation is required at the time of award acceptance.

Award acceptance: please return a countersigned copy of this letter to the program officer within thirty days of receipt.

Page 6: Line-item budget summary (Year 1)

#	Line item	Committed (USD)
1	Station 1 Foundations: fabrication and content	\$12,400
2	Station 2 Iron and Smoke: fabrication and content	\$11,200
3	Station 3 Sunday Mornings: fabrication and content	\$13,800
4	Station 4 Storefronts: fabrication and content	\$10,600
5	Station 5 Marches and Meetings: fabrication and content	\$12,000
6	Station 6 Voter Drives: fabrication and content	\$11,400
7	Station 7 Women and Work: fabrication and content	\$11,800
8	Station 8 Jubilee Singers: fabrication and content	\$10,400
9	Audio booth Studio B build-out	\$9,200
10	Kiosk fleet refresh	\$8,150
11	Conservation supplies bulk Q3	\$3,400
12	Conservation framing batch one (assorted)	\$4,800
13	Conservation framing batch two	\$5,200
14	Conservation framing batch three	\$4,400
15	Recording session technical labor (annual)	\$6,800
16	Volunteer training and stipend program (annual)	\$5,000
17	Press and outreach (annual)	\$4,200
18	Family programming materials (annual)	\$3,600
19	Education tour materials (annual)	\$3,200
20	Wayfinding and signage	\$6,800
21	Opening week catering and reception	\$3,200
22	Conservation framing for Ruthie oral history materials	\$18,400
23	Object photography Q3 to Q1 (annual)	\$2,900
24	Insurance and risk reserve (annual contribution)	\$1,800
25	Program officer travel and site visits (reserve)	\$1,000
Total Year 1		\$150,000

With warm regards on behalf of the Council,

Patricia Ortiz

Program Officer, Voices and Places Program

National Preservation Council

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